a manufacturer had offered a legitimate, valid coupon to a consumer, the coupon then had the potential to be counterfeited. Expiration dates were tampered with and the mass distribution of the phony coupons could cost a company millions of dollars in losses.

Even the most unassuming citizen could be involved with coupon fraud. On the surface, Connie Arvidson of Boca Raton, Florida, seemed a lot like I was in the 1980s: married, desiring to stay home with her young daughter, and using couponing and refunding to help make ends meet. Only for Arvidson, it didn't stop there. "Coupon Connie" got involved in selling counterfeit coupons for free products. Arvidson was convicted for her part in a nationwide scheme to buy and sell counterfeit coupons worth two million dollars. The mastermind in this scheme was a West Texan, used car salesman in his forties, David Rackmill.

Rackmill was arrested in March 1989 by US Postal Inspector Sam Prose. Rackmill was a convicted con man, an ex-crack addict, and a suspect in a non-related mail fraud case. He consented to a search of his trailer that revealed only a few coupons, but also phone bills with lots of calls to "Coupon Connie." After a weekend in jail, Rackmill was ready to deal. His duplex was searched, where hundreds of thousands of counterfeit coupons were found. Rackmill had used a printer to crank out phony high-value coupons such as $9 off Maxwell House and coupons for free Folgers coffee and Luvs diapers. During the next three months, authorities used Rackmill as bait, taping conversations with his clients, including one of his biggest, "Coupon Connie" Arvidson. Over six months' time, she had allegedly paid him between thirty thousand dollars and forty thousand dollars for coupons